

Palmyrene queen

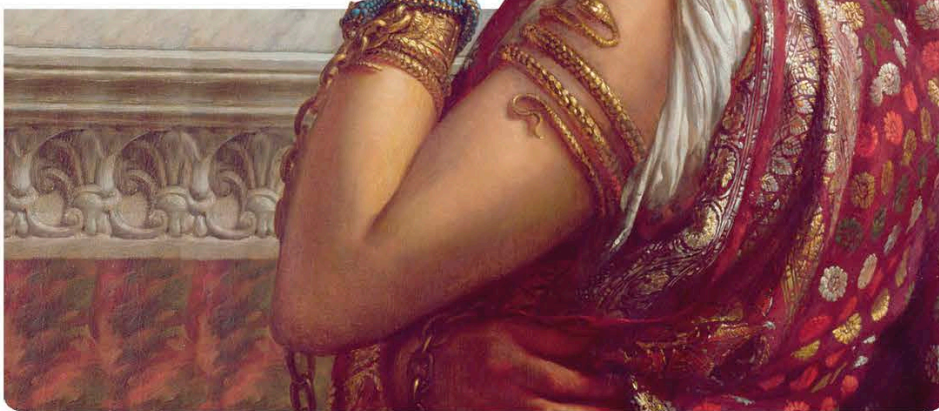
Septimia Zenobia

Where Palmyrene Empire,
Western Asia

When c. 240–c. 274 CE

Zenobia ruled the wealthy city of Palmyra (modern-day Syria), then part of the Roman Empire. At a time of turmoil in Rome, Zenobia seized the chance to set up an independent kingdom and conquered a large part of the Roman Empire. She declared herself empress but was later defeated. In this 19th-century portrait, she is shown in chains.

Headdress decorated with turquoise stones



Aksumite king

Ezana

Where Kingdom of Aksum, Eastern Africa

When c. 303–350 CE

Ezana was the ruler of the ancient city of Aksum in what is now Eritrea and northern Ethiopia. At about the same time that the Roman Empire adopted Christianity, he was converted to the Christian faith by a missionary from Syria. As a result, Aksum became the first Christian kingdom in Africa.

Ezana wears a crown and is flanked by two stalks of wheat.



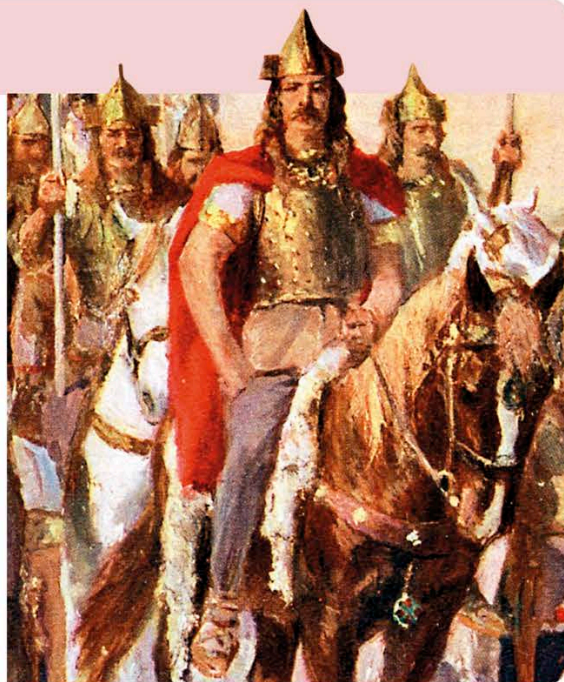
Visigoth leader

Alaric I

Where Parts of Roman
Empire, Europe

When 370–410 CE

The Visigoths were a Germanic people living on the eastern border of the Roman Empire. In 410 CE, their king Alaric I led an army to attack and plunder the city of Rome. This act contributed to the fall of the Western Roman Empire.



Maya ruler

K'inich Janaab' Pakal

Where Palenque,
North America

When 603–683 CE

In 615 CE, at the age of 12, K'inich Janaab' Pakal became the *ajaw* (ruler) of the Maya city-state of Palenque, in modern-day Mexico. His reign of 68 years is one of the longest in history. Pakal's palace at Palenque still stands today.

